INCH-POUND

A-A-52075
July 31, 1990

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

EMBALMING FLUID, ARTERIAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Military Specification MIL-E-1006.

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

1.1 Material and composition. The finished product shall be clear, homogeneous and free from sediment and it shall have an indefinite shelf life. The arterial embalming fluid shall contain a dye as required to give the fluid a distinct red or pink color when examined visually in a clear glass container. The following ingredients shall be included in the finished formulation, expressed in percent by weight, except for the formaldehyde index number which is expressed in grams of formaldehyde per 100 milliliters of solution:

Ingredients	Minimum	Maximum
Formaldehyde index number	20.0	30.0
Blood dissolving compound (sodium tetraborate, dodecahydrate or equivalent)	0.5	6.5
Glycerine or sorbitol	8.0	10.0
Alcohol	7.0	10.0
Wetting agent (Triton X-100 or equivalent)	0.5	----

1.2 Formaldehyde index number test. The method for determining the concentration of formaldehyde in embalming fluid shall be in accordance with ASTM D 2194. The specific gravity, apparent, of the embalming fluid shall be determined in accordance with Method A of ASTM D 891 when the fluid is 20° C. The specific gravity of the embalming fluid multiplied by the percent formaldehyde concentration equals the formaldehyde index number.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: STRNC-ESC, Natick, MA 01760-5014.

AMSC N/A

FSC 9930

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1.3 Prohibited ingredients. The embalming fluid shall contain no more than 5 parts per million of any of the following: antimony, arsenic, lead, mercury, copper, zinc, silver, chloral, cyanide, or alkaloids. Alcohols, other than methanol, ethanol, isopropanol, and ethanol denatured with methanol, shall not be used.

1.4 CID based part identification number (PIN). A document based PIN to identify the embalming fluid is included in section 4. This identification numbering procedure is for Government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

2. QUALITY ASSURANCE

2.1 Certification. The contractor shall certify, and maintain substantiating evidence, that the product offered meets the salient characteristics and requirements of this Commericial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

2.2 Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

3. PACKAGING

3.1 Packaging. Sixteen ounces of embalming fluid shall be packaged in a plastic bottle.

3.1.1 Packing. Twenty four bottles of embalming fluid shall be packed in a fiberboard box conforming to style RSC, type CF (Variety SW) or SF, Class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Box closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

3.2 Palletization. When specified (see 4.2) embalming fluid, packed as specified, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (4-way), type IV or type V in accordance with MIL-STD- 147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C and D, or film bonding means F or G. Pallet pattern shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147.

3.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract of purchase order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The following special marking shall be as shown on the label of each shipping container or palletized unit load:

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Embalming Fluid, Arterial
Flammable
Poison
Formaldehyde Index No. (add)
Manufacturer's Directions for Use (add)

Do not use in the presence of an open flame

Keep container tightly sealed when not in use

Formaldehyde is a carcinogen in animals and therefore is a suspected carcinogen in humans

May contain methanol

May contain Triton X-100

Eye protection is required when using this material

4. NOTES

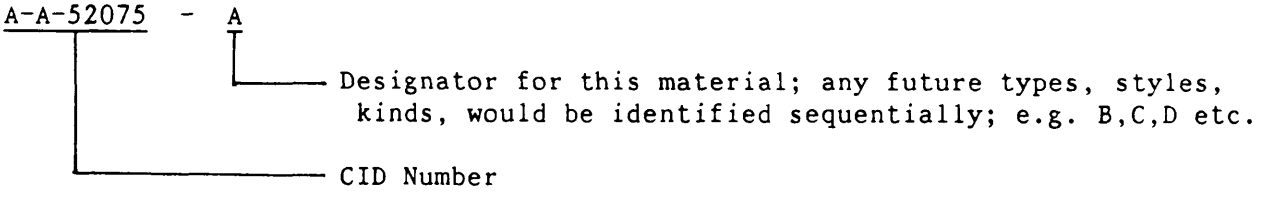
4.1 Intended use. This commercial item description covers embalming fluid for mortuary use in the preparation of human remains for burial.

4.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When palletization is required (see 3.2).

4.3 Material safety data sheets. Contracting officers shall identify those activities requiring copies of completed Material Safety Data Sheets prepared in accordance with FED-STD-313. The pertinent Government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in FED-STD-313.

4.4 Part identification number (PIN). The PIN's to be used for the embalming fluid required by this CID are created as follows:



4.5 Sources of documents.

4.5.1 Sources of nongovernment association documents.

ASTM D 891 - Specific Gravity, Apparent, of Liquid Industrial Chemicals

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ASTM D 2194 - Concentration of Formaldehyde Solutions

Both are available from:

The American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM)
1916 Race Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187

4.5.2 Source of government documents. Copies of military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
BLDG. 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - MS
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD
DLA -GS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project 9930-0114

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